



P43 · 20 PAGES, PRINTABLE + FILLABLE

A First Birthday Planning Kit

A twenty-page planning kit for the first birthday. A 6-week countdown, low-effort theme ideas that are brand-aligned, guest planning, food and cake decisions, the smash-cake-or-not page, a photo shot list with non-cliché options, memory-keeper pages (a letter to baby at one, a family quote-book), and the day-of timeline. Designed so the birthday feels like a milestone, not a stress-induced production.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

The first birthday is a day.

It is not a Pinterest production. It is not a backyard wedding. It is not a brand activation. It is the kid turning one, with cake on their face and a few people who love them in the room.

This kit is the version of planning that respects that. You will not need a vendor. You will not need a "thematic palette." You will not need a balloon arch unless you really want one.

The 6-week countdown is the work. After the countdown, you have a day. The day will be fine. The kid will not remember it. Your photos will.

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This is a planning tool. Allergies and dietary restrictions in your guest list are between you and the families involved.

You do not have to make this huge

This is the page to come back to when you feel the pressure to upgrade.

PERMISSION SLIPS

You are allowed to have 6 guests, not 30.

You are allowed to skip the venue and do it at home.

You are allowed to have a store-bought cake.

You are allowed to skip the smash cake.

You are allowed to skip the balloon arch.

You are allowed to skip a theme entirely.

You are allowed to do it on a different weekend than the actual birthday.

You are allowed to do it in pajamas in the morning.

You are allowed to keep it to two hours.

You are allowed to call it done.

The kid will not remember any of it. You will.

The kit's job is to make sure the day feels good to YOU,
not to perform well on someone else's feed.

Week 6 before

THIS WEEK'S WORK

- ☐ Pick a date. Often the weekend nearest the birthday.
The actual birthday day can be just family if you want.
- ☐ Pick a venue.
 - ☐ Home
 - ☐ Park (have a rain plan)
 - ☐ A small reserved space (community hall, restaurant private room)
 - ☐ Grandparent's house if home is too small
- ☐ Rough guest list. Bigger than you will use, you'll cut it.
- ☐ Pick a theme, OR commit to "no theme, just cute."

THE DATE: _____

THE TIME (suggest 10am-12 or 3-5pm, between naps):

THE VENUE: _____

RAIN PLAN (if outdoor): _____

THEME (if any): _____

ONE THING I AM DOING DIFFERENTLY FROM WHAT EVERYONE EXPECTS:

Week 5 before

THIS WEEK'S WORK

- ☐ Finalize guest list
- ☐ Send invitations (text, email, paper, whatever fits)
- ☐ Order the cake or plan to bake it
- ☐ Decide on smash-cake-or-not (see decision page)
- ☐ Confirm venue if not at home

GUEST LIST FINAL COUNT: _____

INVITE METHOD:

- ☐ Group text
- ☐ Email
- ☐ Paper invitation
- ☐ Phone call to grandparents (a nice touch)

CAKE PLAN:

- ☐ Buying from: _____
- ☐ Baking myself
- ☐ Asking a family member to bake (who: _____)
- ☐ Other: _____

Week 4 before

THIS WEEK'S WORK

- ☐ Track RSVPs
- ☐ Plan the food beyond the cake (see food page)
- ☐ Buy or borrow decor (low-effort version, see theme page)
- ☐ Pick out the baby's outfit
- ☐ Pick out your own outfit (a small joy, often forgotten)

RSVP TRACKER

Confirmed yes: _____ people

Confirmed no: _____ people

Awaiting: _____ people

OUTFIT FOR BABY: _____

OUTFIT FOR ME: _____

OUTFIT FOR PARTNER (if applicable): _____

Week 3 before

THIS WEEK'S WORK

- ☐ Final headcount
- ☐ Plan the timeline of the actual day
- ☐ Decide on activities (none required, see day-of page)
- ☐ Plan any photos you specifically want
- ☐ Notice if anything is creeping in scope and pull it back

A SCOPE CHECK:

What I planned to do at week 6:

What I am about to do now:

Is the second list bigger than the first?

- ☐ Yes (cut something)
- ☐ No (good)

Week 2 before

THIS WEEK'S WORK

- ☐ Order or buy any food that does not need to be fresh
- ☐ Confirm rentals if any (chairs, tables, anything)
- ☐ Check the weather forecast if outdoor
- ☐ Make a shopping list for the cake + day-of food
- ☐ Tell the partner / co-host what you need from them, specifically

WHAT I AM ASKING FOR HELP WITH:

1. _____ (who: _____)
2. _____ (who: _____)
3. _____ (who: _____)

Week 1 before

THIS WEEK'S WORK

- ☐ Final cleaning of the venue if at home
- ☐ Pickup or final prep of food
- ☐ Pickup of cake
- ☐ Charging cameras / phones
- ☐ Confirming photographer (if any)
- ☐ Wrapping the gift you are giving the baby (a small thing if any)
- ☐ The night-before grocery run

THE NIGHT BEFORE:

- ☐ Get the baby to bed at a normal time (do not over-stimulate them)
- ☐ Lay out clothes for everyone in the morning
- ☐ Make sure the cake is in a safe place
- ☐ Phone fully charged
- ☐ Go to bed at a reasonable hour yourself

Theme ideas (low-effort, brand-aligned)

You do not need a theme. If you want one, here are five that do not require expert decorating.

THEME 1: "Just turning one"

Decor: A small banner. Candle. Cake.

Time investment: 30 minutes

Best for: Small home celebration

THEME 2: "Garden / botanical"

Decor: Eucalyptus, small potted plants, sage table runner

Time investment: 2 hours of running around to a florist or hardware store + plant nursery

Best for: Spring or summer birthdays, outdoor setting

THEME 3: "Sage + cream + cake"

Decor: A sage tablecloth, cream napkins, a single cake with one candle. Eucalyptus.

Time investment: 1 hour to set up

Best for: Anyone who likes the Soothemade aesthetic and does not want to invent

THEME 4: "Books + babies"

Decor: A pile of children's books arranged as decor, plus a guestbook that is actually a children's book each guest signs

Time investment: 1 hour

Best for: Households that already have many books and want a meaningful keepsake

THEME 5: "Coffee + pastries"

Decor: A morning party, pastries from a local bakery, coffee for adults, a small cake for the kid

Time investment: A grocery run

Best for: Morning birthdays, low-key gatherings

THE ONE I AM DOING: _____

ANYTHING I AM ADDING / CHANGING:

12

Food + cake

A first-birthday food spread does not have to be elaborate.

THE EASY-WIN FORMAT

One main thing (a sandwich tray, a pasta dish, a few pizzas)

Two sides (a fruit platter, a vegetable platter)

One sweet thing besides the cake (cookies, small pastries)

One drink other than water (lemonade, coffee, tea)

The cake

ALLERGEN NOTES

Common allergens to label or skip:

- ☐ Peanuts / tree nuts
- ☐ Dairy
- ☐ Eggs
- ☐ Wheat / gluten
- ☐ Sesame
- ☐ Soy
- ☐ Shellfish
- ☐ Fish

Label each food clearly. Even better, write what is in each thing on a small card.

THE CAKE

- ☐ Buying it from: _____
- ☐ Pickup date + time: _____
- ☐ Sheet cake (feeds more, costs less) vs round cake (looks prettier)
- ☐ Cake size estimated: _____
- ☐ Candle ready (just the one, or "1")
- ☐ Backup if the cake fails: _____

SHOPPING LIST FOR THE DAY-OF FOOD:

Smash cake, or not

A decision page.

WHAT IS A SMASH CAKE

A small individual cake (often a 4-inch round) given to the baby to literally smash with their hands. Often photographed.

WHY YOU MIGHT DO IT

- ☐ It is a Pinterest-classic photo set
- ☐ The kid loves cake and food
- ☐ You want a specific memory

WHY YOU MIGHT NOT DO IT

- ☐ It is messy and the kid may hate it
- ☐ Babies sometimes do not actually like the experience of frosting
- ☐ You do not want sugar yet
- ☐ It is one more thing to organize

VARIATIONS IF YOU WANT THE PHOTO BUT NOT THE MESS

- ☐ A "smash bagel" or "smash muffin" instead (less sugar, lower mess)
- ☐ A smash fruit (a small bowl of berries to mash)
- ☐ Skip the smash, just give the baby a slice of the main cake

MY DECISION:

- ☐ Yes, traditional smash cake
- ☐ Yes, a variation (which: _____)
- ☐ No smash, just regular cake at the party
- ☐ No cake involved, just photos with candles and the family

THE PHOTO SETUP IF I AM DOING IT:

- ☐ Plain backdrop (sheet, paper, wall)
- ☐ High chair or floor on a sheet
- ☐ Bib + soft outfit (something I do not mind throwing out if the frosting wins)
- ☐ Towel + change of clothes ready

Photo shot list

The classic ones. And the ones nobody else is taking.

CLASSIC SHOTS (the ones grandparents want)

- ☐ Baby with the cake before
- ☐ Baby with the cake after (the destroyed cake)
- ☐ Baby blowing out (or attempting to blow out) the candle
- ☐ Family group photo
- ☐ Baby with each grandparent
- ☐ Baby with each parent
- ☐ The cake itself, undamaged
- ☐ The "before opening any presents" photo
- ☐ Baby's outfit + smash-cake aftermath outfit transition

NON-CLICHÉ SHOTS

- ☐ Baby's hand reaching for something
- ☐ The room before guests arrived
- ☐ The candle as it is being lit, in soft light
- ☐ The pile of shoes by the door
- ☐ A grandparent's hands on the baby's back
- ☐ The baby asleep at some point (it always happens)
- ☐ The kitchen mid-chaos
- ☐ The view of the table from a low angle (baby's perspective)
- ☐ Your own hands cutting the cake
- ☐ The baby with someone they have only just met
- ☐ The cleanup, half done

WHO IS TAKING THE PHOTOS

- ☐ A friend who is the unofficial photographer
- ☐ A hired photographer
- ☐ Just family on phones, all of us
- ☐ My partner is on photo duty

The "I want to be IN the photos too" reminder:

Memory keepers

A letter and a quote-book to fill in.

A LETTER TO MY BABY AT ONE

DATE: _____

Dear _____:

THE THINGS YOU LOVE RIGHT NOW

Food: _____

Toy: _____

Word or sound: _____

Person: _____

Place: _____

THE THING YOU DID THIS WEEK THAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

A WISH I HAVE FOR YOU IN YOUR SECOND YEAR

I love you. I am writing this on the day of your first birthday.

Love,

The family quote-book

Hand this to guests. They write a small note for the baby to read at 18.

FROM: _____

A MESSAGE FOR THE FUTURE ONE-YEAR-OLD WHEN THEY ARE EIGHTEEN

FROM: _____

FROM: _____

FROM: _____

FROM: _____

(Add additional pages as needed for more guests.)

Day-of timeline

For nobody to have to ask “when is X.”

MORNING (BEFORE GUESTS)

- __:__ Wake up (parent + baby)
- __:__ Get the food + space set up
- __:__ Get yourself + baby dressed
- __:__ Final cleanup pass
- __:__ First guests arrive

DURING THE PARTY

- __:__ Guests arrive (open the door, hug, point to drinks)
- __:__ Mingling, baby plays
- __:__ Group photo (do this early, before the cake)
- __:__ Food served
- __:__ Cake + singing happy birthday
- __:__ Smash cake (if doing)
- __:__ Cards or quote-book signing
- __:__ Last guests leave

AFTER

- __:__ Cleanup begins
- __:__ Baby nap or bedtime (likely earlier than usual, party kids are often overstimulated)
- __:__ Adults can sit down

A NOTE: PARTIES THAT END BY 2-2.5 HOURS WORK BETTER FOR ONE-YEAR-OLDS. LONGER PARTIES MEAN OVERTIRED MELTDOWN AT THE END, BOTH KID + PARENT.

A SECOND NOTE: HAVE A PLAN FOR THE LAST GUEST WHO STAYS TOO LONG. A LINE LIKE "WE ARE SO GLAD YOU CAME, BABY IS ABOUT TO HIT NAP TIME" IS FINE.

A final note

You planned a day. You showed up for the cake. You took photos. You held the kid. You ate a small slice of cake yourself.

The party is the smaller part. The year you spent learning who they are is the bigger part.

The letter you wrote, the photos you took, the quote-book your guests signed, those are the things you will pull out at five years old, at ten, at eighteen. The kid will not remember the cake. They will read the letter.

You made it through year one. That is the milestone the cake is actually for.

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Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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